Graphic Design

Mood Board Creation

Summary Notes

Contents

3 Lesson outcomes

3 Introduction

3 Mood boards

4 Design cycle

4 Why is a mood board important?

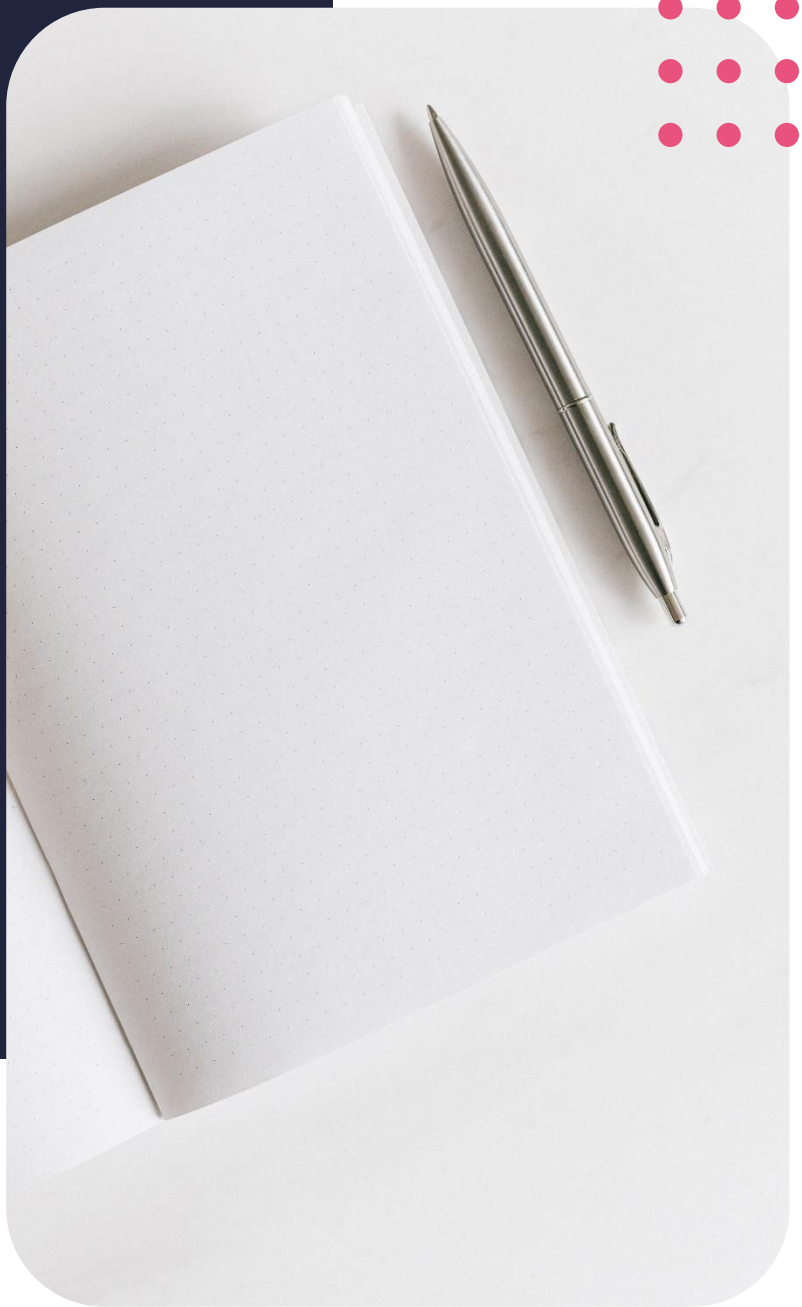
4 Steps to create a mood board

5 Colour schemes

6 Creating a mood board

7 Conclusion

7 References



Lesson outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Lesson outcome 1: Mood boards
- Lesson outcome 2: Design cycle
- Lesson outcome 3: Why is a mood board important?
- Lesson outcome 4: Colour schemes
- Lesson outcome 5: Creating a mood board

Introduction

Coming up with a colour scheme can be a daunting task, especially if you are new to it.
A great way to help inspire you is by simply taking a picture of elements that you think work well together – especially nature scenes as nature barely gets it wrong.
Then, simply import the photo in your desired program and sample those colours.
If you have not created a Pinterest account by now, I recommend you do this – Pinterest is also a great tool to help you with inspiration.
Oscar Wilde, Irish poet and playwright believed that colour has a thousand ways to speak to one's soul. The use of colour has a bigger impact than we can ever imagine and understanding how to communicate with colour, can make your designs extremely successful.

Mood Boards

Mood boards can be used for any creative project and is a great way to help communicate your intended message to your client.

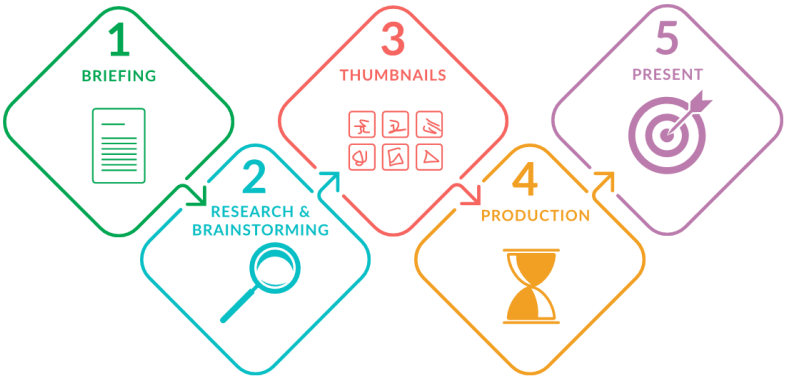
So, what exactly is a mood board?

A mood board is a visual representation that establishes a design flow for a project. It is a collection of possible colours, images, fonts and textures. It also helps communicate your designs visually to your client and make it easier for them to visualise the end result. Mood boards help you let your creative juices flow - they can be any size or shape and can be used for any creative project from fashion design, interior design or even architecture, not only graphic design.

A mood board is not a must in your design project but there are a lot of benefits to making use of a mood board in the research & brainstorming phase during your design cycle.

Design Cycle

The five stages of the design cycle are briefing, research & brainstorming, thumbnails, production and present. A mood board is thus created in the 2nd or research and brainstorming phase.



Why is a mood board important?

A mood board is not a must in your design project but there are a lot of benefits to making use of a mood board in the brainstorming phase during your design cycle.

A mood board helps to determine whether you and your client are on the same page when it comes to design concepts before you start with the design concept

It also aids in bringing you and your client's ideas together

It is a powerful tool to collaborate, especially if you work with a team of other creatives where your ideas can be shared

It helps giving clarity and provides a visual story to tell

It aids in presenting your work professionally and with confidence, thus making your client more at ease and feeling confident with your services

It is the perfect starting point to get things done and it helps create momentum, direction and provides clarity in times you feel like you're stuck in a creative rut.

Steps to create a mood board

Make a note of these steps when creating a mood board, after a while, they should come naturally though.

Pick your size & shape of your mood board, this can be any size or shape, from square to circular or even a triangle. I however find that a square or rectangle works best for me personally.

Choose your theme – most times, your client would have provided you with some valuable information to determine this in the client briefing. If you are simply creating it for yourself, it would be a good idea to have a theme before you move onto creating a mood board

Personalise your mood board with images, fonts, colours & textures or any other ideas and inspiration you find fit.

Describe your mood board detail with engaging annotations if necessary

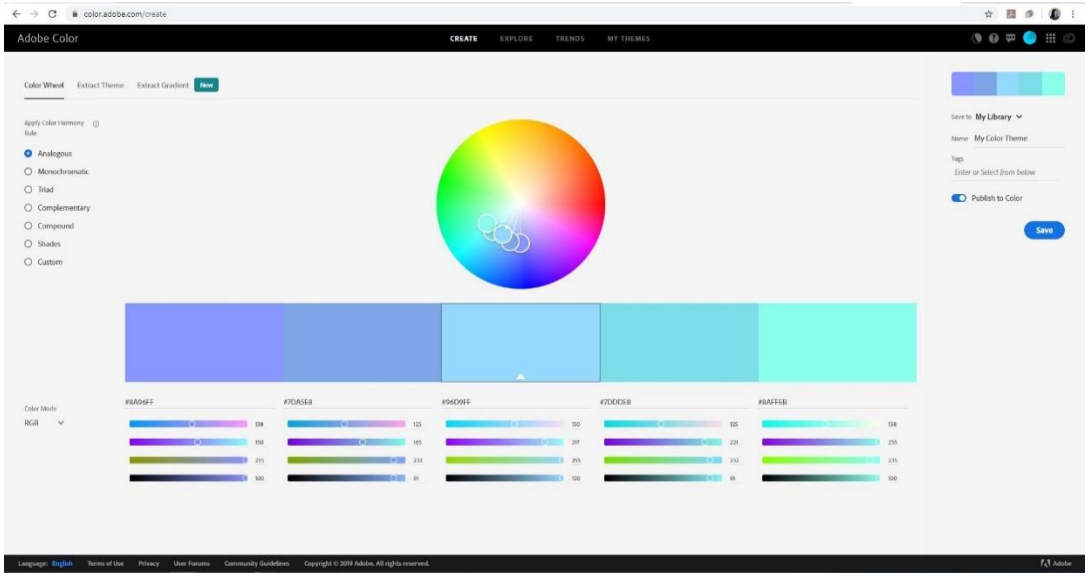
Present your mood board to your client or rest of your design team

Colour schemes

Moving over to a topic we have also touched on in our previous module, I would like show you a clever way to work with colour schemes. Colour schemes are a crucial part during mood board creation since it plays an important role in communicating the correct mood to your target audience. Knowing and understanding the message a certain colour conveys is one thing but combining a variety of colours to form a design is yet another topic on its own. As you know, a colour scheme is a combination of two or more colours that work well together and speak with one voice. The type of message you would want to convey also plays an important role in the selection of colours. Thinking of a bright red and yellow colour scheme, you will immediately feel anxious or it might seem overwhelming, but considering what it is used for, will make you look at it differently. Bright red and yellow will not work for branding at a hospital but it will certainly draw your attention if you want to convey a warning message in the form of a warning sign.

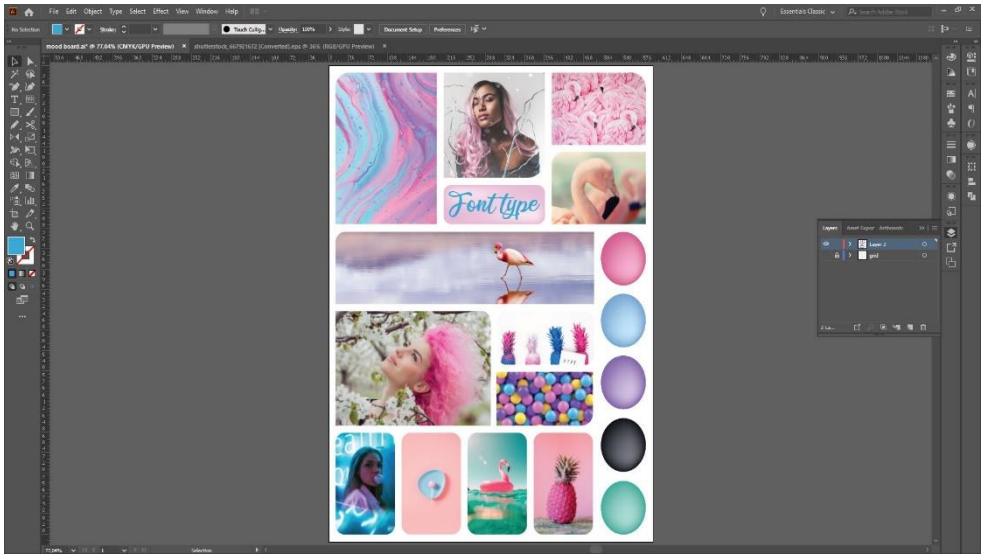
This is where Adobe colour comes in…

Has anyone heard of or perhaps made use of Adobe Colour? If not, today will be the day that you are going to thank me for introducing this amazing feature to you. Also, for Adobe Creative Cloud account users, there will be even more benefits to using this feature – you will be able to save your colour schemes and load it directly into the Adobe programs you have been learning. But if not, you can simply copy the colour codes and paste it into your colour palette.

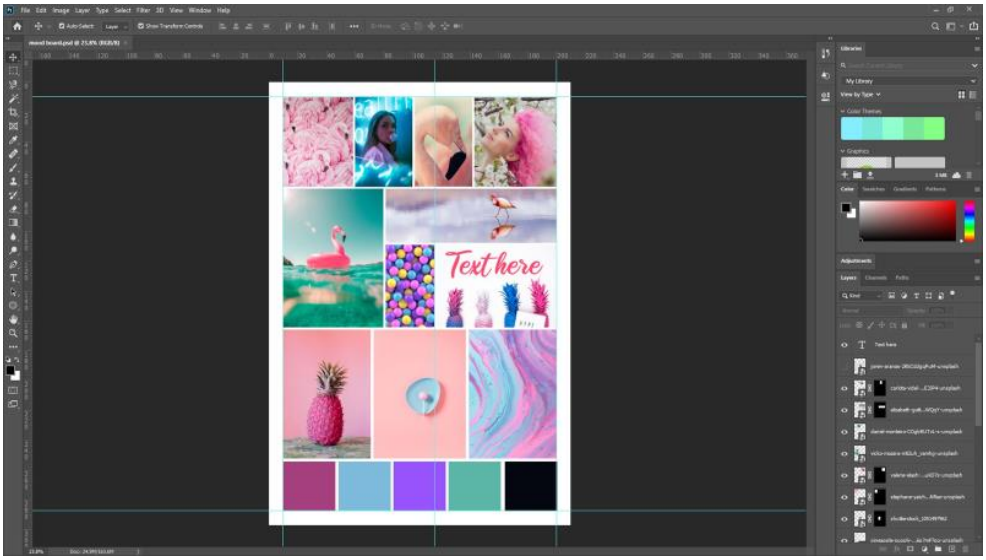


Creating a mood board

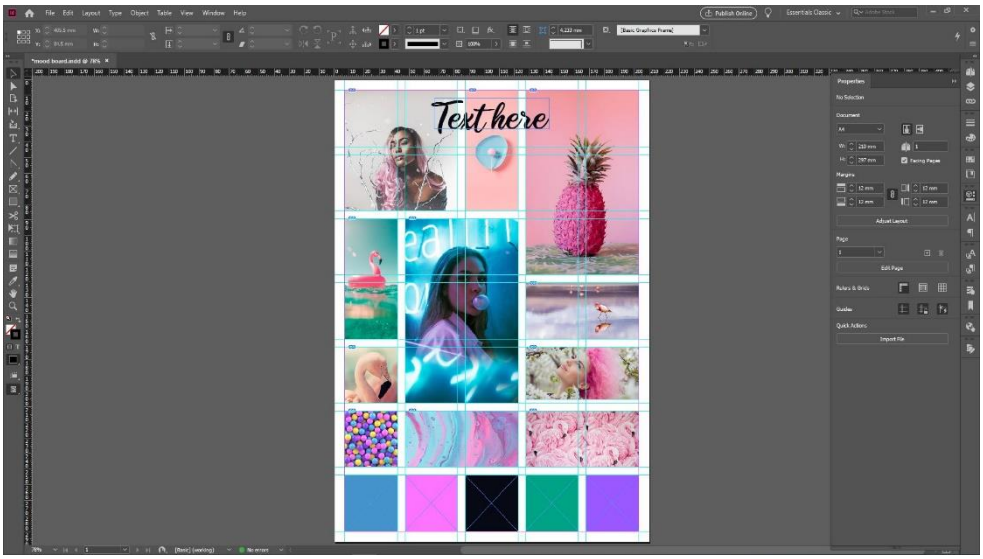
For this lesson, I would like to show you how to create your own mood board in Illustrator, Photoshop as well as InDesign. I think this will put the different programs and how they work into more perspective. I found InDesign to be the most effective for this task simply because it is a layout program and cut out to do tasks just like this. However, both Illustrator and Photoshop are equally as good at creating mood boards – it just took longer.



Mood board created in Adobe Illustrator – follow the lesson to view the demo step by step



Mood board created in Adobe Photoshop – follow the lesson to view the demo step by step



Mood board created in Adobe InDesign – follow the lesson to view the demo step by step

Mood boards are a quick and effective way to bring together all your ideas and concepts. Which program are you going to make use of to design your mood board? There is no right or wrong here but presenting a mood board professionally might just convince your client to rather take your idea than their original idea because sometimes, our clients know what they want but don't know how to get there – and that's where you, the industry expert comes in.

These images I used today were specifically sources from unsplash.com and pixabay.com

Conclusion

Our lesson today was all about working with colours and then also presenting your rough ideas to your clients in a clever and professional way by making use of mood boards. Colour, being one of the most important elements in design was looked at and we discovered that Adobe Colour is an amazing tool to aid you in creating beautiful colour schemes.

References

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